Initially, Messflix has analysts and development teams. The development teams are data producers, while the analysts and possibly other teams in our example are data consumers.

Our initial MVP platform focuses mostly on the data consumers in applying platform thinking. Let's explore the workflows to understand why. If we take a look at the data analyst workflow, it typically consists of steps such as these:

1. Browsing datasets
2. Finding the right dataset
3. Exploring and understanding it
4. Possibly combining it with others

The MVP platform allows a data analyst to combine almost all of these steps into one or two. Browsing and finding the right dataset as well as understanding it can all be done by reading the data catalog. Combining datasets, at least from the technical perspective, is easy because they all come in CSV format. Figure 7.5 depicts the comparison of these two workflows.

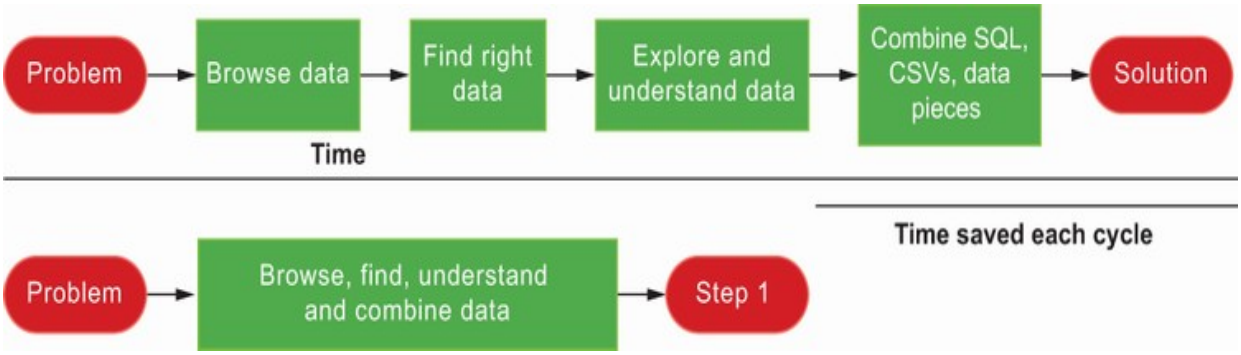


Figure 7.5 The analyst workflow speeds up, thanks to the platform.

The MVP platform thus saves a substantial amount of time for data analysts each time they go through their Problem > Solution cycle.